

NEIVA J. FORTES

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EDUCATION

Syracuse University

2022–Present

Ph.D. in Economics, expected May 2027

Dissertation: Essays in the Economics of Education and Health

Dissertation Committee: Monica Deza (Chair), John Cawley, Maria Zhu, and Ying Shi

Hartwick College

2018–2022

B.A. in Mathematics and Economics, summa cum laude

RESEARCH FIELDS

Economics of Education, Health Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Crime

WORKING PAPERS

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying” (*Job Market Paper*)

Presented at FLX Economics of Education Workshop (2026); at APPAM (poster 2026) and SEA (2026).

Using nationwide school-level civil-rights data and staggered-adoption, synthetic-control, and synthetic difference-in-differences designs, this paper examines how state recess mandates affect discriminatory bullying allegations.

Results indicate increases in reported sex-based allegations following strong mandates, while estimates for race- and disability-based allegations are less consistent. The findings are consistent with changes in exposure, detection, or reporting during unstructured school time.

“The Effect of Height on Adolescents’ Body Image Perceptions and Behaviors”

with Monica Deza and Maria Zhu

NBER Working Paper No. 35293, June 2026. DOI: 10.3386/w35293. [NBER page](#)

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Sibling Spillover Effects of Chronic Illness on Educational and Labor Market Outcomes”

“Height and Bullying: Descriptive Evidence from the YRBSS”

“The Effects of High School Students’ Class Choices on College Outcomes”

“The Effects of Free Jail Call Implementation on Inmates’ Behaviors”

CONFERENCE AND INVITED PRESENTATIONS

* *Scheduled*

Southern Economic Association 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX

Nov. 2026*

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying”

APPAM Annual Fall Research Conference

Nov. 2026*

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying” (poster)

FLX Economics of Education Workshop, Syracuse, NY

May 2026

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying”

Center for Policy Research Poster Reception, Syracuse University

2026

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying”

Center for Policy Research Poster Reception, Syracuse University

2025

“The Effects of State-Mandated Recess Laws on Youth Crime”

Invited Seminar, Hartwick College, Oneonta, NY

2025

“The Effects of State-Mandated Elementary School Recess Laws on Discriminatory Bullying”

SELECTED WORKSHOPS AND PROGRAMS

NBER Summer Institute, Economics of Crime, Cambridge, MA	July 2026
Chicago Price Theory Summer Camp, University of Chicago	June 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Center for Policy Research, Syracuse University <i>NIA T32 Predoctoral Training Program in Policy, Place, Population Health, and Aging (P3HA) Trainee; faculty supervisor: John Cawley</i>	2026-Present
Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Syracuse University <i>Faculty supervisor: John Cawley</i>	2025–2026
Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Syracuse University <i>Faculty supervisors: Monica Deza and Yulya Truskinovsky</i>	2024–2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Principles of Microeconomics (ECN 101), Syracuse University <i>Enrollment: 12 students (2024), 22 students (2025), and 6 students (2026)</i>	Summers 2024–2026
Teaching Assistant, Intermediate Microeconomics (ECN 301), Syracuse University <i>Enrollment: Approximately 50-60 students</i>	2023–2024
Teaching Assistant, Hartwick College	Jan. 2022

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND HONORS

Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation and Thesis Research	2025–2026
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Syracuse University	2023–2024
McNair Fellowship, Syracuse University	2022–2023

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Director of Admissions, Hartwick College	Jan. 2022
Small Business Coordinator, National Development Council	2021–2022

LANGUAGES

English (fluent) | Cape Verdean Creole (fluent) | Portuguese (fluent) | Spanish (intermediate)